

1 PURPOSE AND SCOPE

- 1.1 This glossary defines terms and abbreviations used by Assurance Services International (ASI) for all Accreditation related activities.

2 CHANGE HISTORY

Version number	Date of approval (Effective date)	Description of changes
1.0	11/08/2010	First publication
1.1	31/01/2012	Unknown
2.0	29/09/2014	Major review
2.1	30/09/2015	Changes on technical scopes; adding of definition of Technical Subscope. Adding GSTC scopes.
2.2	05/12/2016	Modification to definitions of affiliate and Head Office and subcontractor. Addition of key Certification activities.
3.0	06/02/2017	Major review: addition and modification of definitions to align with current procedures (i.e. Assessment Findings, Witness Assessment and Compliance, etc.); deletion of definitions (i.e. unneeded, non-applicable or repeated definitions, Audit related definitions replaced by: Assessment, ASI Report, Observation, grading of Nonconformities, etc.). Removal of program-specific scopes. Addition of table of abbreviations.
3.1	11/05/2017	Conflict of Interest updated
3.2	16/03/2018	Formatting changes; no content changes.
3.3	17/01/2019	Logo, name and ASI abbreviation updated.
3.4	23/04/2019	Change of Affiliate Office definition. Addition of Subcontracting and Engaging Personnel definitions.
4.0	01/08/2019	Review to ensure that all definitions included in public ASI procedures match the glossary and are included in it (unless they context of the particular document where they are indicated is needed for understanding). Capitalization of all definitions and change of format. Addition and changes of definition to reflect new Accreditation Procedure.
4.1	08/05/2020	Changes to reflect the Assessment Findings Procedure V6.0. Remote Assessment modified to match public procedure. Shortened Unannounced Compliance Assessment definition.
4.2	08/12/2020	Changes to reflect Appeals Procedure version 6.0 (removal of definition of Appeal Panel) and removal of section 4 (associated documentation).
5.0	15/10/2022	Review to ensure that definitions in public ASI procedures match the glossary and are included in it (unless the context of the particular document where they are indicated is needed for understanding). Inclusion of definitions relevant to Two-Tier Assurance Program (TTAP). ASI Logo update.
5.1	01/07/2023	Modification of the definition of incidents. Addition of the definition of incident investigation.
5.2	10/04/2024	Format changes to match new branding. No further content changes.
5.3	27/05/2024	Minor typo in the definition of CAB System Appraisal was removed.

3 TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

- 3.1 All terms and definitions are provided in this Glossary or under the specific public ASI QMS documents.

4 GLOSSARY

Term	Definition
Accreditation	Third-party attestation related to a Conformity Assessment Body conveying formal demonstration of its competence to carry out specific Conformity Assessment tasks (Source: ISO/IEC 17011:2017).
Accreditation Body	Authoritative body that performs Accreditation (Source: ISO/IEC 17011:2017)
Accreditation Certificate	Formal document or a set of documents, issued by ASI to a Conformity Assessment Body, stating that Accreditation has been granted for the defined Scope of Accreditation.
Accreditation Committee (AC)	A committee responsible for making Accreditation Decisions on Granting, renewing, Extending and Reducing technical scope, Suspending and Withdrawing Accreditation. When making a decision, the AC acts as a representative of ASI, and the decision is consequently attributed to ASI.
Accreditation Cycle	Begins at or after the initial Accreditation Decision date or decision after a Reaccreditation Assessment and shall not be longer than five years. Before the end of a cycle, a Reaccreditation Assessment shall be conducted prior to cycle expiration.
Accreditation Decision	Decision on Granting, Maintaining, Extending, Reducing, Suspending and Withdrawing accreditation.
Accreditation Management System (AMS)	ASI's cloud-based data management system. <i>Note: Conformity Assessment Bodies are granted limited access to the Accreditation Management System via the CAB Portal.</i>
Accreditation Report	The report prepared by ASI for the Accreditation Committee used to support the recommendation for an Accreditation Decision.
Accreditation Requirements	Entirety of requirements the Conformity Assessment Body has to fulfil to qualify for being Accredited to a certain Certification Scheme and for maintaining such Accreditation. Some of these requirements are set by ASI (ASI Accreditation Requirements) and others are set by the Scheme Owner (SO Accreditation Requirements).
Approved Entity	The specific legal entity that has been granted Approval by ASI under the Two-Tier Assurance Program.
Accredited Entity	The specific legal entity that has been granted Accreditation by an Accreditation Body.

Affiliate Office (AO)	A legal entity that performs at least one Key Certification Activity on behalf of the CAB. See below for definition of key certification activities. <i>Note: Such legal entities need to be recorded in the ASI CAB AMS.</i>
Appeal	Request by a Conformity Assessment Body to ASI for reconsideration of any adverse Accreditation decision made by ASI related to its desired Accreditation status (adapted from ISO/IEC 17011:2017).
Appeal Parties	The Appellant and ASI constitute the parties of the Appeal.
Appellant	The Conformity Assessment Body that is appealing the decision made by ASI.
Applicant Conformity Assessment Body	A Conformity Assessment Body applying for ASI Accreditation/Approval or requesting extension of the Scope of Accreditation/Approval.
ASI Approval (Decision)	ASI confirmation that the CAB complies with the ASI Approval Requirements and SO Requirements and can provide certification services within their Scope of Approval, provided that the CAB also holds a valid Accreditation from a Participating AB as per the ASI Two-Tier Assurance Program.
ASI Approval Requirements	Those requirements which are set up by ASI and which the CAB has to fulfill to qualify for being approved to a Certification Scheme and for maintaining such approval. These are contained in the documents (information documents, policies, procedures and templates) listed in ASI-INF-20-120 'Controlled List of Public ASI QMS Documents' and published on ASI's website (www.asi-assurance.org/s/quality).
ASI Accreditation Requirements	Those Accreditation Requirements which are set by ASI. These are currently contained in the documents (information documents, policies, procedures, guidance and templates) listed in section 4 of ASI-INF-20-120 'Controlled List of Public ASI QMS Documents' and published on ASI's website (www.asi-assurance.org). As far as the listed documents incorporate other publicly available documents by reference, further requirements set up in such other documents are also considered part of the ASI Accreditation Requirements.
ASI Facilitator	An individual who supports an ASI Assessor during a Remote Assessment through the use of appropriate Information and Communications Technology (ICT), including but not limited to video conferences, remote interviews and site tours.
ASI Logo	The logo used by ASI to identify itself.
ASI Two-Tier Assurance Program	The ASI program that integrates Accreditation (Tier One) and complementary ASI Assurance Services (Tier Two) to ensure the overall integrity for Scheme Owners and their claims:

	• Tier One: Consists of the Accreditation of Conformity Assessment Bodies (CABs) by Participating Accreditation Bodies (Participating ABs) with mandatory ASI participation in Accreditation Assessments, leading to an Accreditation Decision. • Tier Two: Consists of the complementary Assurance Services provided by ASI, leading to an ASI Approval Decision.
Assessment	Process undertaken by ASI to determine the competence of a Conformity Assessment Body based on applicable Requirements, standard(s) and/or other normative documents including the Conformity Assessment Body's own documented system for a defined Scope of Accreditation. Types of ASI Assessments include: • Desk Review or Desk Assessment • Office Assessments (including Head and Affiliate Offices) • Witness Assessment • Compliance Assessment • Traceability and Forensic Assessment Assessments can be planned as Regular, Extra, Short Notice or Unannounced and can be conducted onsite or remotely. <i>Note: ASI uses the terms Assessment and Assessor to describe Accreditation/Approval activities performed by its own personnel, and Audit and Auditor to describe activities performed by Conformity Assessment Bodies.</i>
Assessment Agenda	A description of the activities and arrangements for an ASI Assessment.
Assessment Budget	The estimated costs of an ASI Assessment. This normally includes time for preparation, Assessment, Technical Review, report writing and finalization as well as Team members including translators and Technical Experts, if applicable.
Assessment Criteria	A set of policies, procedures or requirements used as a reference against which Assessment Evidence is compared (adapted from ISO 9000:2015).
Assessment Evidence	Records, statements of fact or other information which are relevant to the Assessment Criteria and verifiable (adapted from ISO 9000:2015).
Assessment Findings	Results of the evaluation of the collected Assessment evidence against Assessment criteria. Findings may indicate Conformity or Nonconformity .
Assessment Report	A report of an Assessment of the Conformity Assessment Body by ASI.
Assessment Scope	Extent and boundaries of an Assessment. <i>Note: The Assessment Scope generally includes a description of the physical and virtual locations, functions, organizational units, activities and processes as well as the time period covered (adapted from ISO 19011:2018).</i>

Assessment Team	One or more Assessors conducting an Assessment, supported if needed by Technical Experts. <i>Note: The Assessment Team may include trainee Assessors.</i>
Assessment Technique	The manner in which ASI conducts an Assessment. The Assessment techniques are fully onsite, fully remote, partly remote/partly offsite and remote with facilitator onsite.
Assessor	Person assigned by ASI to perform, alone or as part of an Assessment Team, an Assessment of a Conformity Assessment Body. <i>Note: ASI uses the terms Assessment and Assessor to describe Accreditation activities performed by its own personnel, and Audit and Auditor to describe activities performed by Conformity Assessment Bodies.</i>
ASI North America PB LLC (ASI NA)	A wholly owned subsidiary with limited liabilities of FSC AC, constituted as Delaware LLC, the Participating AB appointed to accredit CABs with head offices based outside the EEA and UK.
Assurance Services	Any and all independent and impartial ASI Assessment or other relevant activities that ensure the integrity of Scheme Owner's systems and their claims.
Audit	Systematic, independent and documented process conducted by a Conformity Assessment Body for obtaining Objective Evidence and evaluating it objectively to determine the extent to which the Audit criteria are fulfilled. (adapted from ISO 9000:2015).
Auditor	Person who conducts an Audit. (Source ISO 9000:2015). <i>Note: ASI uses the terms Assessment and Assessor to describe Accreditation activities performed by its own personnel, and Audit and Auditor to describe activities performed by Conformity Assessment Bodies.</i>
CAB Performance Review (CPR)	An umbrella term used to denote all aspects of a CAB's implementation of their management systems, as recorded by ASI. This is based on assessment information and other factors that affect a CAB's performance gathered by ASI throughout the previous surveillance year. It may affect ASI's oversight level of the CAB for the next surveillance year. The CPR includes (amongst other things) an Appraisal Checklist and resulting CAB score and a CPR Report that is shared annually with the CAB.
CAB Portal	Portal created for Conformity Assessment Bodies to access ASI's cloud-based data management system.
CAB System Appraisal	A system evaluation based on a set of checklist items that appraises the strengths and weaknesses of the CAB's management systems
Certification	Formal recognition by a Conformity Assessment Body that a legal entity has demonstrated compliance with all Certification standards.

Certification Scheme	Certification system related to Management Systems or specified products to which the same specified requirements, specific rules and procedures apply.
Combined ASI Assessment	An Assessment of a single Conformity Assessment Body's Management System against two or more sets of Assessment Criteria (i.e. two or more programs) conducted at the same time. ASI May carry out combined Assessments at the level of the Conformity Assessment Body's Head Office or Affiliate Offices. This term does NOT include Assessments that were planned separately under the normal planning procedure, but happen to occur during the same week.
Complainant	A person, organization or a representative of an organization filing a Complaint.
Complaint	An expression of dissatisfaction, other than Appeal or Incident, by any person or organization to ASI relating to the activities of ASI, of an accredited Conformity Assessment Body or of a certificate holder where a response is expected (adapted from ISO/IEC 17011:2017).
Complaint Party	Any person(s) or organization(s) related to the Complaint. The parties shall include, at a minimum, the Complainant named on the Complaint submission form and the organization that is the focus of the Complaint.
Compliance Assessment	An ASI Assessment conducted on a certificate holder to evaluate the compliance of a Conformity Assessment Body's Certification processes and certificate holders Management System against Certification requirements.
Compliance Follow-up (CFU) Finding	An ASI finding, identified during any ASI Assessment, in which ASI identifies issues at CH level that are not related to the CAB's performance but for which the CAB has to directly follow up with the CH. Depending on the criticality, ASI may request the CAB to follow up within an abbreviated timeline or immediately.
Conflict of Interest (COI)	Any circumstance in which the interest of ASI differs from those of an individual acting on its behalf. In such circumstances, the impartiality and professional responsibilities of an individual are, could be or may appear to be compromised. Thus, Conflict of Interest can be actual, potential or perceived.
Conformity	The fulfilment of a requirement.
Conformity Assessment Body (CAB)	Body that performs Conformity Assessment Services and that can be the object of Accreditation (Source ISO/IEC 17011:2017) and of Approval. <i>Note: The terms Conformity Assessment Body and Certification body are considered equivalent and ASI uses the terms interchangeably. ASI usage generally follows conventions adopted by Scheme Owners.</i>

Conformity Assessment Activity	Any activity conducted by a Conformity Assessment Body when assessing conformity including but not limited to testing, calibration, inspection, Certification of Management Systems, persons, products, processes and services, provision of proficiency testing, production of reference materials and validation and verification (Source ISO 17011:2017).
Contractor	An individual contracted by ASI to fulfil a specific role or task, including Assessors and non-Assessors, such as Technical Experts, Local Experts and translators.
Correction	An action to eliminate a detected Nonconformity (Source ISO 9000:2015).
Corrective Action (CA)	An action to eliminate the cause of a Nonconformity and to prevent recurrence. There can be more than one cause for a Nonconformity (Source ISO 9000:2015).
Dispute	An umbrella term for Appeals, Complaints and Incidents received by ASI for processing through the ASI prescribed Dispute management procedures.
Desk Review or Desk Assessment	An ASI Assessment type conducted fully remotely in which ASI principally reviews documents, but may also include the use of other related/relevant information sources (e.g. interviews), with the aim of evaluating the applicant or accredited/approved CAB's conformity with accreditation/approval requirements.
Effective Date	The date when a decision, agreement or other document comes into force. In the case of an ASI Quality Management System document, the date of approval is equivalent to Effective Date unless otherwise stated.
Errors Of Fact (EOF)	A statement by a Conformity Assessment Body claiming an inaccuracy or a mistake in the content of an ASI Assessment Finding or in the content of an Accreditation Report.
Extending Accreditation	Adding Conformity Assessment Activities to the Scope of Accreditation (Source 17011:2017).
Extra Assessment	An assessment planned in addition to the ASI surveillance assessment programme as determined by ASI's Sampling Procedure.
Extraordinary Events or Circumstances	Circumstances beyond the control of the organisation, commonly referred to as "Force Majeure" or "act of God", that may temporarily prevent ASI from carrying out oversight and planned assessments of accredited CABs. Examples include war, strike, riot, political instability, geopolitical tension, terrorism, crime, pandemic, flooding, earthquake, malicious computer hacking, other natural or man-made disasters (adapted from IAF-ID 3: 2011)
Feedback Meeting	A meeting held between ASI and the certificate holder at the end of a Compliance Assessment.

Granting Accreditation	Awarding accreditation for a defined Scope of Accreditation (Source ISO 17011:2017).
Head Office (HO)	Organizational unit or office declared as the “main” or “head office” by the top management of the Conformity Assessment Body.
Head Office Assessment	An ASI Assessment of the Conformity Assessment Body’s Head Office.
Home AB (Home Accreditation Body)	Under the ASI Two-Tier Accreditation Program (TTAP), when multiple ABs offer services for a scheme, one AB has to be appointed as “Home AB” for a particular Scheme. The Home AB is the Participating AB that carries out the review of the scheme in order to identify areas of potential mis-alignment with ISO 17065 and related documents, in view of achieving EA approval
Incident	Any reported suspected or actual wrongdoing that threatens the reputation and/or integrity of the ASI assurance program and/or its associated “Scheme Owner” and cannot be considered under the relevant ASI procedures for Complaints and Appeals. <i><u>Note 1: Incidents differ from Complaints in that they are not reported following the ASI Complaints Procedure and/or can be reported anonymously. The need for a response from ASI varies according to the priority, as opposed to Complaints where a response is always required.</u></i> <i><u>Note 2: Incidents differ from Appeals in that anyone can report an Incident, whereas Appeals are only available to CABs in relation to Nonconformities (NCs) or Accreditation/Approval Decisions.</u></i>
Incident Investigation	An ASI evaluation of one or more Incidents pertaining to the same topic, CAB, CH or region. An Incident Investigation culminates in an investigation report with recommendations to minimize, mitigate or prevent further threats to the credibility of ASI and/or the Scheme Owner.
Integrity Investigation	A type of Incident Response triggered when an Incident or series of Incidents represent a major Integrity Risk to a Scheme Owner’s Certification system. ASI and the scheme determine if an Integrity Investigation is warranted. Such investigations are often conducted in collaboration with the Scheme Owner, and may include a series of Incident Responses, culminating in an Investigation report with recommendations to remediate and prevent Integrity Risks.
Introductory Meeting	A meeting held between ASI and the certificate holder at the beginning of a Compliance Assessment.
Key Certification Activities	Key Certification Activities include but are not limited to: • Certification decision-making • Development of policies, processes and/or procedures • Training and/or management of Certification personnel • Drafting, reviewing, and signing contracts with clients, including Technical Review of applications and quotes

	• Planning and scheduling of Certification activities • Monitoring of Certification activities (e.g. tracking Audit and Nonconformity deadlines) • Auditing certificate holders • Technical report reviewing
Maintaining Accreditation	Confirming the continuance of Accreditation for a defined Scope.
Management System	A set of policies, procedures and practices an organization needs to follow in order to meet its own objectives. A Management System can address a single discipline or several disciplines, e.g. quality management, financial management or environmental management (Source ISO 9000:2015).
Material Testing	Includes sampling and physical analysis by an independent and competent laboratory of certified material for certain characteristics, e.g. species, pollutants, ingredients or origin.
May	Denotes a permitted course of action, within the limits of the requirement.
Nonconformity (NC)	The non-fulfilment of a requirement.
Objective Evidence	Verifiable information or records pertaining to the quality of an item or service or to the existence and implementation of a quality system element, which is based on visual observation, measurement or test. Data supporting the existence or verity of something (Source ISO 9000:2015 && ISO 19011:2018).
Observer	A person who accompanies the Assessment Team during an Assessment but does not act as an Assessor. An Observer can be from the auditee, Scheme Owner, a regulator or other interested party who witnesses the Assessment. <i>Note: An Observer (e.g. trainee Assessor, ASI staff member, Scheme Owner representative) is not part of the Assessment Team and does not influence or interfere with the conduct of the Assessment. However, a trainee Assessor may be given certain tasks during the Assessment under supervision.</i>
Office Assessment	An ASI Assessment type conducted onsite and/or remotely to determine the competence of the Conformity Assessment Body to carry out Conformity Assessment Activities in accordance with all Accreditation Requirements by reviewing and evaluating implementation of its Management System and documented procedures. Office Assessments can be conducted at the ad Office or at Affiliate Offices.
Onsite NC Verification Assessment	Onsite Assessment (e.g Office, Witness or Compliance) at either the Conformity Assessment Body or the certificate holder to follow up and verify closure of a particular Nonconformity. <i>Note: ASI does onsite Verification in the case that there is no upcoming Office Assessment, and a remote review is insufficient to close the Nonconformity.</i>

Opportunity For Improvement (OFI)	An ASI finding where the evidence observed indicates that a requirement has been met, but based on ASI Assessment team's professional experience and knowledge, improved performance and/or implementation may be possible.
Oversight	Refers to ASI's Accreditation and Assurance activities
Participating Accreditation Body	An Accreditation Body operating under the framework of (EC) 765/2008 in the European Economic Area (EEA) and of UKAS operating under the regulation on Accreditation and Market Surveillance No 765:2008 (GB RAMS) in the UK and ASI North America PB LLC that has established a cooperation with ASI to provide Accreditation for any of the Scheme Owners under the ASI Two-Tier Assurance Program.
Pausing of (Re)-Accreditation process	A temporary halt in the (re)accreditation process to provide time for resolution of NCs or any conditions or concerns regarding the CAB or the process. <i><u>Note:</u> This is not a sanction and is different from Suspension or Withdrawal.</i>
Quality Management System (QMS)	Part of a Management System with regard to quality.
Reaccreditation Assessment	Assessment performed to renew the Accreditation Cycle. This Assessment shall confirm the competence of the Conformity Assessment Body and shall cover all the requirements of the standard(s) for which the Conformity Assessment Body is Accredited. An Accreditation decision shall be made after the Reaccreditation Assessment.
Reducing Accreditation	Cancelling part of the Scope of Accreditation. (Source ISO 17011:2017).
Regular Assessment	An assessment planned as part of the ASI surveillance assessment programme as determined by ASI's Sampling Procedure.
Remote Assessment	Any Assessment of a Conformity Assessment Body conducted by ASI in full or in part using electronic means and that does not take place at the physical location of the CAB or a CAB's Certificate Holder (CH).
Root Cause	The source or origin of a Nonconformity, as well as any contributing factors involved.
Root Cause Analysis (RCA)	Analysis tool to determine the root cause of a problem including an evaluation of the extent and scale of the problem identified to determine if it has occurred elsewhere.
Sanction	An action taken by ASI in response to a failure by the Conformity Assessment Body to meet its Accreditation/Approval obligations. A Sanction is not the same as a Nonconformity.

Scheme Owner (SO) Requirements	Those Requirements which are set up by the Scheme Owner of the relevant Scheme, with which CABs have to comply in order to provide the relevant certification services. These are contained in documents (e.g. standards, policies, procedures, advice notes etc.) published by the Scheme Owner. As far as these documents incorporate other publicly available documents by reference (e.g. ISO standards), further requirements set up in such other documents are also considered part of the SO Requirements.
Scope of Accreditation	Specific Conformity Assessment Services for which Accreditation is sought or has been granted (Source ISO/IEC 17011:2017). <i>Note: ASI divides its Scope of Accreditation into technical Scope as defined by the Scheme Owner and geographical scope.</i>
Shall	Denotes a requirement.
Short Notice Assessment	Any ASI Assessment announced on short notice (no more than two weeks prior to the Assessment).
Should	Denotes a requirement that shall be followed unless there are reasons not to, in which case the justification shall be recorded.
Stakeholder	Any individual or group with an interest or claim (whether stated or implied) which has the potential of being impacted by or having an impact on a given project and its objectives.
Subcontracting	Also known as “outsourcing”. It refers to contracting a third party to provide specific Certification Activities on behalf of the Conformity Assessment Body under a legally binding agreement. The Conformity Assessment Body accepts full responsibility and liability for specifying and for accepting/rejecting the service provided by the Subcontracted organization /entity. Specification of the service may include references to personnel (e.g. on qualification, experience, conduct, etc.) to be engaged by the third party but such references do not constitute Engaging Personnel.
Summary of Findings (SOF)	A compilation of findings and recommendations of the ASI Assessment Team provided in writing after the closing meeting of an Assessment.
Suspension of Accreditation	The process of putting temporary restrictions in place for all or part of the Scope of Accreditation (Source ISO 17011:2017).
Technical Expert	A person assigned by ASI, working under the responsibility of an Assessor, who provides specific knowledge or expertise to the ASI Assessment Team relating to the organization, the process or activity to be assessed, or language, local conditions or culture. A Technical Expert is not expected to have Assessor qualifications and training. <i>Note: Technical Expert is also used as an umbrella term referring to Technical Experts, Local Experts and translators.</i>

Technical Review (TR)	A review of each ASI Assessment Report conducted by a selected team of Assessors before the report is signed off and sent to the Conformity Assessment Body.
Technical Subscope	Specific Conformity Assessment Services which are subtypes of technical Scopes of Accreditation. ASI divides technical Scopes into Technical Subscopes as defined by the Certification Schemes.
Traceability and Forensic Assessment	Specific type of ASI Assessment triggered only when Conformity Assessment Bodies do not compliantly follow up on issues raised and are applied by ASI over the course of Traceability and Forensic Investigations.
Transaction Verification	A process in which Conformity Assessment Bodies and/or ASI verify that Certification input and output claims for materials produced or traded by certificate holders are accurate and match the claims of their respective trading partners.
Unannounced Compliance Assessment	A Compliance Assessment conducted without previous announcement of the Assessment date and time to the CH, neither by ASI nor the CAB. The CAB is previously informed.
Withdrawal of Accreditation	The process of cancelling Accreditation for the full Scope (Source ISO 17011:2017)
Witness Assessment	Process in which ASI observes and evaluates a Conformity Assessment Body carrying out Conformity Assessment Services within its Scope of Accreditation (adapted from ISO/IEC 17011:2017).

5 ABBREVIATIONS

5.1 The abbreviations listed below also include terms not mentioned within this glossary but in other ASI Quality Management document.

AB	Accreditation Body
AC	ASI Accreditation Committee
AO	Affiliate Office
AMS	Accreditation Management System
ASC	Aquaculture Stewardship Council
ASI	Assurance Services International
BOD	ASI Board of Directors
CA	Corrective action
CAB	Conformity assessment body
CH	Certificate Holder
COC	Chain of Custody
COI	Conflict of Interest
CW	Controlled Wood
EOF	Errors Of Fact

FM	Forest Management
FSC ®	Forest Stewardship Council ®
FSC AC	Forest Stewardship Council Asociación Civil, Oaxaca, Mexico
FSC GD	Forest Stewardship Council Global Development GmbH
FSC IC	Forest Stewardship Council International Center GmbH, Bonn, Germany
GSTC	Global Sustainable Tourism Council
HO	Head Office
IUCN	International Union for Conservation of Nature
MD	Managing Director
MSC	Marine Stewardship Council
NC	Nonconformity
OFI	Opportunity For improvement
P&C	Principles And Criteria
PA	Preventive action
RCA	Root cause analysis
RSB	Roundtable on Sustainable Biomaterials
RSPO	Roundtable on Sustainable Palm Oil
SBP	Sustainable Biomass Partnership
SCC	Supply Chain Certification
SO	Scheme Owner
SOF	Summary Of Findings
T+F	Traceability and Forensics

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